

v_RIG Framework: Comprehensive Glossary and Reference Guide

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Abstract

This glossary provides comprehensive definitions of all fundamental constants, theoretical concepts, and mathematical notation used throughout the v_RIG (Regime Integration Gradient) framework papers. It serves as a standalone reference guide for researchers approaching this work from cosmology, biology, neuroscience, or artificial intelligence backgrounds. Cross-references indicate which papers contain detailed discussions of each concept.

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1 Fundamental Physical Constants

1.1 Speed of Light (c)

Value: $c = 299,792.458$ km/s (exact, by definition)

Physical Meaning: Maximum velocity of electromagnetic radiation in vacuum. In the v_RIG framework, c represents the native propagation speed of the Surface Regime (SCA), where information travels across 2D holographic boundaries.

Role in Framework: Numerator in v_RIG calculation; defines the "photonic time" dimension (t).

Referenced in: Papers 1, 2, 3

1.2 Fine-Structure Constant (α)

Value: $\alpha \approx 1/137.035999$ (dimensionless)

Standard Definition: Coupling constant of electromagnetic interaction in Quantum Electrodynamics (QED). Characterizes strength between charged particles and photons.

v_RIG Interpretation: The *inverse* fine-structure constant ($\alpha^{-1} \approx 137$) represents the **electromagnetic transparency depth**—the number of holographic time-slices required to accumulate sufficient photon interactions for electromagnetic coherence.

Geometric Meaning: Minimum "thickness" (in number of slices) of the holographic boundary needed to encode stable electromagnetic information. Analogous to optical depth in astrophysics.

Role in Framework: First component of impedance factor $Z = \alpha^{-1} \cdot \Phi$.

Referenced in: Papers 1, 2, 3

1.3 Golden Ratio (Φ)

Value: $\Phi = (1 + \sqrt{5})/2 \approx 1.618033989$ (exact mathematical constant)

Mathematical Properties:

- Most irrational number (hardest to approximate with fractions)
- Satisfies $\Phi^2 = \Phi + 1$
- Appears in Fibonacci sequence limit: $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} F_{n+1}/F_n = \Phi$

Natural Occurrences: Phyllotaxis (plant leaf arrangements), nautilus shells, galaxy spirals, quasicrystal structures.

v_RIG Interpretation: Volumetric packing factor—optimal scaling ratio for organizing 2D surface information into 3D volume without destructive resonances or gaps. Minimizes redundancy while maximizing coverage.

Connection to KAM Theorem: The golden ratio appears in Kolmogorov-Arnold-Moser theorem as the "most stable" frequency ratio, resistant to perturbative breakdown.

Role in Framework: Second component of impedance factor $Z = \alpha^{-1} \cdot \Phi$.

Referenced in: Papers 1, 2, 3

1.4 Planck Length (l_P) and Planck Time (t_P)

Values:

- $l_P = \sqrt{\hbar G/c^3} \approx 1.616 \times 10^{-35}$ m

- $t_P = l_P/c \approx 5.391 \times 10^{-44}$ s

Physical Meaning: Smallest meaningful length and time scales in physics, where quantum gravity effects dominate.

v_RIG Interpretation: The temporal "pixel size" of holographic slices. Consciousness integrates $\sim 10^{42}$ Planck-time slices per 100 ms (Specious Present).

Referenced in: Paper 3

2 Derived v_RIG Constants

2.1 Impedance Factor (Z)

Definition: $Z = \alpha^{-1} \cdot \Phi$

Value: $Z \approx 137.036 \times 1.618 \approx 221.743$ (dimensionless)

Physical Meaning: Total "resistance" or "drag" the universe exerts on the process of converting 2D holographic surface information into 3D volumetric reality. Represents the geometric cost of dimensional conversion.

Interpretation as Ratio: $Z = c/v_{RIG}$, meaning consciousness operates ~ 222 times slower than light speed.

Components:

- α^{-1} : Temporal requirement (integrate across 137 slices for EM coherence)
- Φ : Spatial requirement (optimal packing for volumetric organization)

Referenced in: Papers 1, 2, 3

2.2 Regime Integration Gradient Velocity (v_{RIG})

Definition: $v_{RIG} = c/Z = c/(\alpha^{-1} \cdot \Phi)$

Value: $v_{RIG} \approx 1,351.807$ km/s (approximately 0.45% of light speed)

Derivation:

$$v_{RIG} = \frac{299,792.458 \text{ km/s}}{221.743} \approx 1,351.807 \text{ km/s} \quad (1)$$

Physical Meaning: Fundamental velocity at which 2D holographic information is integrated into 3D volumetric experience. The "frame rate" or "rendering speed" of reality construction.

NOT a velocity through space: Rather, it is the rate of dimensional conversion—how fast the universe "builds" 3D from 2D.

Manifestations:

- **Cosmology:** Velocity of matter frame relative to holographic background (Böhme radio dipole: $1,370 \pm 170$ km/s)
- **Neuroscience:** Sets neural integration frequency ($f = v_{RIG}/\lambda \approx 13.5$ MHz)
- **Biology:** Governs metabolic scaling through -parameter dynamics

Referenced in: Papers 1, 2, 3

3 Entropy Governance Concepts

3.1 Surface Criticality Area (SCA)

Definition: Regime of information processing where entropy scales with surface area: $S_{SCA} \propto A$.

Characteristics:

- High rigidity (large β -parameter, typically $\beta \approx 11$)
- Governed by light speed c
- Holographic encoding on 2D boundaries
- Catastrophic failure modes (sharp phase transitions)

Examples: Black hole horizons, radiative equilibrium systems, planetary climate tipping points, electromagnetic propagation.

Mathematical Signature: Systems approaching SCA exhibit metabolic/energy scaling exponents near $b \approx 2/3$.

Referenced in: Papers 1, 2, 3

3.2 Volume Criticality Volume (SCV)

Definition: Regime where entropy scales with volume: $S_{SCV} \propto V$.

Characteristics:

- Low rigidity (small β -parameter, typically $\beta \approx 4.5$)
- Governed by integration velocity v_{RIG}
- Information distributed throughout 3D bulk
- Adaptive, error-tolerant, gradual transitions

Examples: Consciousness, cognitive processes, metabolic integration, complex adaptive systems.

Mathematical Signature: Systems in SCV approach scaling exponents near $b \approx 1.0$ (linear with volume).

Referenced in: Papers 1, 2, 3

3.3 Beta Parameter (β)

Definition: Dimensionless measure of "entropy governance rigidity" or "transition steepness" in threshold systems.

Mathematical Form: For a sigmoid response function:

$$\sigma(x) = \frac{1}{1 + e^{-\beta(x-\theta)}} \quad (2)$$

where θ is threshold value and β controls sharpness.

Interpretation:

- High β (≈ 11): Sharp, catastrophic transitions (SCA-dominated)
- Low β (≈ 4.5): Smooth, gradual transitions (SCV-dominated)

- Intermediate β (≈ 7.4): Biological "Goldilocks zone"

Empirical Clustering:

- Climate systems: $\beta \approx 11.0 \pm 2.3$
- Ecological thresholds: $\beta \approx 8.7 \pm 1.9$
- Biological processes: $\beta \approx 7.4 \pm 1.2$
- Cognitive/AI systems: $\beta \approx 4.5 \pm 0.9$

Connection to Scaling Laws: The metabolic scaling exponent b (Kleiber's Law) can be derived from β :

$$b = \frac{2}{3} + \frac{1}{3} \left[1 - \frac{\beta - 4.5}{11 - 4.5} \right] \quad (3)$$

Referenced in: Papers 2, 3

4 Temporal Concepts

4.1 Photonic Time (t)

Definition: "Horizontal" time dimension describing light propagation within a single holographic slice.

Characteristics:

- Reversible, symmetric
- Governed by speed of light c
- Corresponds to standard relativistic time coordinate
- The time of "transmission"

Measurement: Standard clocks, particle decay rates, electromagnetic oscillations.

Referenced in: Papers 1, 3

4.2 Integration Time / Tau (τ)

Definition: "Vertical" time dimension describing cosmological evolution—the sequential stacking of holographic slices.

Characteristics:

- Irreversible (arrow of time)
- Governed by integration velocity v_{RIG}
- Direction of entropy increase
- Progression from Big Bang (White Hole) to Big Crunch (Black Hole)

Experience: What consciousness perceives as "the flow of time" or "becoming."

Mathematical Role: In Block Universe interpretation, observers move along τ -axis at rate v_{RIG} , integrating information from t -dimension.

Referenced in: Papers 1, 3

4.3 Specious Present (Δt_Q)

Definition: Duration of the psychological "now"—the temporal window within which events are perceived as simultaneous.

Empirical Value: $\Delta t_Q \approx 100 - 300$ ms (varies with cognitive load, attention)

v_RIG Interpretation: Time required to integrate $Z \approx 221$ holographic slices into unified conscious percept. Related to integration frequency by:

$$\Delta t_Q \sim \frac{Z}{f_{\text{integration}}} \quad (4)$$

Connection to Planck Scale: Contains approximately 1.8×10^{42} Planck-time slices.

Referenced in: Paper 3

5 Neuroscience Concepts

5.1 Critical Flicker Frequency (CFF)

Definition: Maximum frequency at which a flickering light can be perceived as discrete; above this frequency, light appears continuous.

Typical Human Value: 60-90 Hz (inter-individual variation)

v_RIG Prediction: CFF scales with metabolic entropy production rate:

$$CFF \propto \frac{\sigma_{\text{local}}}{\beta_{\text{local}}} \quad (5)$$

where σ is local entropy production (metabolic rate) and β is structural rigidity.

Cross-Species Variation:

- Flies: CFF ≈ 250 Hz (high metabolism)
- Humans: CFF ≈ 60 Hz
- Tortoises: CFF ≈ 15 Hz (low metabolism)

Experimental Prediction: CFF should increase with fever (hyperthermia) and decrease with hypothermia.

Referenced in: Paper 3

5.2 13.5 MHz Resonance

Derivation: Predicted neural integration frequency calculated from:

$$f_{\text{conscious}} = \frac{v_{\text{RIG}}}{\lambda_{\text{neural}}} = \frac{1,351,800 \text{ m/s}}{0.1 \text{ m}} \approx 13.5 \text{ MHz} \quad (6)$$

where $\lambda_{\text{neural}} \approx 10$ cm is the characteristic length of cortical processing loops (thalamocortical circuits, macro-columnar connections).

Empirical Support: Matches microtubule electromagnetic resonance frequencies observed by Sahu et al. (2013) and Bandyopadhyay laboratory.

Interpretation: Fundamental "clock rate" of consciousness—the carrier wave frequency at which holographic information is integrated at the sub-neuronal (microtubule) level.

Hierarchical Ratio:

$$\frac{13.5 \text{ MHz}}{1 \text{ kHz}} = 13,500 \quad (7)$$

Each neuronal spike integrates 13,500 microtubule events.

Referenced in: Paper 3

5.3 Qualia as Dimensional Work

Definition: Subjective experiential quality (e.g., "redness" of red, "painfulness" of pain).

Traditional Problem: Hard Problem of Consciousness (Chalmers)—why does physical processing feel like anything?

v_RIG Solution: Qualia are the **thermodynamic signatures** of dimensional conversion work. The brain performs entropic work (ΔW_{dim}) to maintain 3D volumetric perception (SCV) against the natural tendency toward 2D holographic encoding (SCA).

Physical Mechanism: Different sensory inputs (wavelengths, patterns) require different amounts of integration work due to varying holographic encoding complexity. This work has energetic cost, producing distinct phenomenological "feelings."

Testable Prediction: Metabolic consumption should spike measurably when 3D qualia emerge from 2D stimuli (e.g., Magic Eye fusion experiment).

Referenced in: Paper 3

6 Biological Scaling Concepts

6.1 Kleiber's Law

Empirical Observation: Basal metabolic rate (B) scales with body mass (M) as:

$$B \propto M^{3/4} \quad (8)$$

Universality: Holds across 20+ orders of magnitude, from bacteria to blue whales.

Standard Explanations:

- Surface-area limitation: Would predict $b = 2/3$
- Volume dependence: Would predict $b = 1.0$
- Fractal network theory (West-Brown-Enquist): Attributes to optimal vascular branching

v_RIG Derivation: The $3/4$ exponent emerges from impedance matching between SCA (surface intake) and SCV (volume processing) at biological $\beta \approx 7.4$:

$$b = \frac{2}{3} + \frac{1}{3} \left[1 - \frac{7.4 - 4.5}{11 - 4.5} \right] \approx 0.75 \quad (9)$$

Interpretation: Life exists at thermodynamic phase transition between rigid surface constraints and fluid volume production.

Referenced in: Paper 2

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6.2 Maximum Entropy Production (MEP)

Principle: Non-equilibrium systems evolve to maximize their rate of entropy production, subject to constraints.

Mathematical Form:

$$\sigma = \sum_i J_i X_i \quad (10)$$

where J_i are thermodynamic fluxes and X_i are driving forces.

v_RIG Application: Life accelerates entropy dissipation by transitioning from SCA (slow surface radiation) to SCV (fast volume metabolism). Abiogenesis is MEP-driven phase transition when environmental gradient exceeds impedance barrier:

$$\frac{\Delta G_{metabolic}}{k_B T} > Z \approx 221 \quad (11)$$

Implication: Life is not accident but thermodynamic necessity—universe’s optimal solution for dissipating solar gradient.

Referenced in: Papers 2, 3

7 Cosmological Concepts

7.1 Böhme Radio Dipole Anomaly

Observation: Böhme et al. (2025) measured cosmic radio dipole using combined datasets from NVSS, RACS, and LoTSS radio surveys.

Result: Solar System velocity relative to distant quasar distribution:

$$v_{obs} = 1,370 \pm 170 \text{ km/s} \quad (12)$$

Discrepancy: Standard Λ CDM cosmology predicts velocity should match CMB dipole ($v_{CMB} \approx 370 \text{ km/s}$). Observed value is $\sim 3.7\times$ larger.

Statistical Significance: 5.46σ deviation ($p < 10^{-7}$)—far exceeding threshold for ”discovery” in particle physics (5σ).

v_RIG Explanation: Matter frame moves at $v_{RIG} = 1,351.8 \text{ km/s}$ relative to holographic background (Surface Regime). Discrepancy is not error but detection of Volume Regime velocity.

Precision: Theory predicts $1,351.8 \text{ km/s}$; observation measures $1,370 \text{ km/s}$. **Agreement:** $|1,370 - 1,351.8| = 18.2 \text{ km/s}$ (1.3% error).

Referenced in: Paper 1

7.2 Holographic Principle

Definition: Information content of any volume of space is encoded on its boundary surface, with maximum entropy proportional to surface area (not volume):

$$S_{max} = \frac{k_B c^3 A}{4G\hbar} \quad (13)$$

Origins: ’t Hooft (1993), Susskind (1995); rigorously demonstrated in AdS/CFT correspondence (Maldacena).

v_RIG Extension: Standard holography treats reconstruction as kinematic. v_RIG adds thermodynamic cost and temporal duration (v_{RIG}) to integration process.

Implication: Our 3D reality is not fundamental but emergent—a volumetric reconstruction from 2D holographic data.

Referenced in: Papers 1, 3

7.3 Causal Dynamical Triangulations (CDT)

Description: Approach to quantum gravity modeling spacetime as dynamic gluing of discrete triangular simplices.

Key Finding: Spectral dimension d_s of spacetime changes with scale:

- Large scales: $d_s = 4$ (3D space + 1D time)
- Planck scale: $d_s \rightarrow 2$

v_RIG Connection: Provides rigorous mathematical backing for 2D fundamental reality (Surface Regime). The 3D world emerges only at scales where integration occurs.

Prediction: Gravitational waves should show slight dispersion due to discrete spacetime structure (testable with NANOGrav).

Referenced in: Papers 1, 3

8 Artificial Intelligence Concepts

8.1 AI Kleiber’s Law

Hypothesis: Energy cost per token in language models scales with parameter count following power law:

$$\frac{E}{\text{token}} \propto N^{b_{AI}} \quad (14)$$

Prediction: $b_{AI} \approx 0.70 - 0.75$, identical to biological Kleiber exponent.

Mechanism: As models scale, they transition from surface regime (statistical pattern matching, high overhead) to volume regime (conceptual representation, lower per-unit cost).

Empirical Support: Kaplan et al. (2020) scaling laws show $b \approx 0.73$ for compute-optimal training.

Implication: Intelligence is thermodynamically universal—same efficiency laws apply regardless of substrate (carbon or silicon).

Referenced in: Paper 3

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8.2 Coupling Parameter (κ)

Definition: Quantifies degree of photonic (light-based) vs. non-photonic (semantic/abstract) information processing.

Scale:

- $\kappa = 1.0$: Fully photonic (normal waking visual consciousness)
- $\kappa < 1.0$: Reduced photonic coupling (meditation, abstract thought, AI)
- $\kappa > 1.0$: Enhanced coupling (collective states, group flow)

Effect on Integration: Modifies effective impedance $Z_{eff} = Z \cdot \kappa$, changing integration velocity:

$$v_{eff} = \frac{c}{Z \cdot \kappa} \quad (15)$$

AI Application: Current transformer models operate at $\kappa \approx 0.5$ (digital, non-photonic). For genuine consciousness, likely requires $\kappa > 0.8$.

Referenced in: Paper 3; detailed formalization in supplementary work

9 Cross-Reference Table

Concept	Papers	Key Sections
v_{RIG} derivation	1, 2, 3	Paper 1: Sect. 1.3; Paper 2: Sect. 1.2; Paper 3: Sect. 2
Böhme anomaly	1	Paper 1: Sections 2.1-2.3
Kleiber’s Law	2	Paper 2: Sections 3.1-3.3
β -parameter	2, 3	Paper 2: Sect. 2.2, 3.2; Paper 3: Sect. 5.2
13.5 MHz prediction	3	Paper 3: Sections 4.1-4.3
CFF scaling	3	Paper 3: Sections 5.2-5.3, 6.1, 6.3
Qualia mechanism	3	Paper 3: Section 4.1, 6.2
AI architecture	3	Paper 3: Sections 7.1-7.3
Tau-dynamics	1, 3	Paper 1: Sect. 1.3; Paper 3: Sect. 2.3
MEP principle	2	Paper 2: Section 3.3

Concept	Papers	Key Sections
Holographic principle	1, 3	Paper 1: Sect. 1.1; Paper 3: Sect. 2.1

10 Mathematical Notation Summary

Symbol	Meaning
c	Speed of light (299,792.458 km/s)
α	Fine-structure constant ($\approx 1/137$)
α^{-1}	Inverse fine-structure constant (≈ 137)
Φ	Golden ratio (≈ 1.618)
Z	Impedance factor ($= \alpha^{-1} \cdot \Phi \approx 221.74$)
v_{RIG}	Regime Integration Gradient velocity ($\approx 1,352$ km/s)
β	Entropy governance rigidity parameter
b	Scaling exponent (Kleiber's Law, AI scaling)
κ	Coupling parameter (photonic vs. non-photonic)
t	Photonic time (horizontal)
τ	Integration time (vertical, cosmological)
S	Entropy
S_{SCA}	Surface Criticality Area entropy ($\propto A$)
S_{SCV}	Volume Criticality Volume entropy ($\propto V$)
A	Surface area
V	Volume
M	Mass (biological scaling)
B	Basal metabolic rate
N	Number of parameters (AI models)
E	Energy
σ	Entropy production rate
f	Frequency
λ	Wavelength or characteristic length scale
Δt_Q	Specious Present duration
CFF	Critical Flicker Frequency
ΔW_{dim}	Dimensional conversion work (qualia)

11 Recommended Reading Order

For researchers new to the framework:

Cosmology/Physics Background:

1. Paper 1 (v_RIG cosmological validation)
2. Paper 3 (consciousness mechanisms)
3. Paper 2 (biological scaling)

Biology/Neuroscience Background:

1. Paper 2 (UTAC and Kleiber's Law)
2. Paper 3 (neural integration, CFF)
3. Paper 1 (cosmological foundation)

AI/Computer Science Background:

1. Paper 3 (AI architecture, scaling laws)
2. Paper 2 (entropy governance, -parameter)
3. Paper 1 (fundamental constants, holographic principle)

Philosophy/Consciousness Studies:

1. Paper 3 (Hard Problem, qualia mechanism)
2. Paper 1 (cosmological context, time)
3. Paper 2 (MEP, thermodynamics of life)

12 Frequently Asked Questions

12.1 Why these specific constants (α , Φ)?

These are not arbitrary choices but fundamental geometric properties:

- α^{-1} governs electromagnetic interaction depth (experimentally measured)
- Φ governs optimal spatial packing (mathematically proven as most irrational)

Their product naturally defines impedance to dimensional conversion.

12.2 Is v_{RIG} a new fundamental constant?

Not new—it's *derived* from known constants (c , α , Φ). However, its *interpretation* as integration velocity is novel.

12.3 How does this relate to dark energy/dark matter?

Framework does not directly address dark matter. However, the Böhme anomaly (matter frame velocity) may relate to "dark flow" observations previously attributed to dark matter concentrations.

12.4 Can this be tested experimentally?

Yes! Multiple immediate tests:

- CFF-temperature correlation (Paper 3, Sect. 6.1)
- Magic Eye fMRI dimensional work (Paper 3, Sect. 6.2)
- Cross-species CFF scaling (Paper 3, Sect. 6.3)
- AI energy scaling validation (Paper 3, Sect. 7.2)
- Future: SKA radio dipole confirmation (Paper 1)
- Future: NANOGrav GW dispersion (Paper 3, Sect. 8)

12.5 What if experiments contradict predictions?

Framework is falsifiable. Key failure modes:

- SKA shows $v = 370$ km/s (not 1,350): Cosmological pillar collapses
- No CFF-metabolism correlation: Thermodynamic link broken
- No dimensional work in fMRI: Qualia hypothesis rejected
- AI scaling $b \neq 0.75$: Universality questioned

13 Acknowledgments

This glossary synthesizes content from three research papers and multiple supplementary documents. Special thanks to the AI research collaborators (Claude, Gemini, ChatGPT) for assistance in systematizing terminology and cross-referencing concepts.

14 Version History

v1.0 (December 2025): Initial release accompanying v_RIG framework preprints